

Resuming non-Basmati rice export is nice news

India's **resumption** of non-basmati rice exports **is** the **outcome** of stable prices and increase in output. Wholesale rice prices are declining and **retail price inflation** is back in single digits after a lengthy **sojourn** above 10%. Paddy **acreage** reported for the main kharif crop **is** higher than last year on a **stable** monsoon. Output and price trends would indicate there is little reason for GoI to make supply side **interventions** through export **curbs** and **overextended stockpiling**. All this is welcome news. **India**, the world's largest exporter of rice, **has** had to justify its **pursuit** of food security **at home** while **adding to** global **vulnerabilities**. The supply **intervention** has also faced **scrutiny** over the impact on cereal prices that remained **stubbornly** high. **Stockpiling** of grain remains a **contested** policy India **continues** to **pursue amid** questions over its warehousing capacity.

Despite export curbs, India's **share** of world rice exports **declined** by less than a quarter. This is because of the nation's competitive advantage slipping. The next two **countries** in the list of exporters, Thailand and Vietnam, **managed to** place the same amount of rice in the global bowl as India did with bans and duties **in place**. **China**, the world's biggest rice producer, **does** not offer it for trade because of its massive domestic consumption. With the top two sources out of the market for a key food group, the **effect** on global nutrition security **is considerable**. Besides, India's surplus in rice production is **fed** by price supports that prioritise food security over nutritional security. The excess paddy acreage **results in deficient** pulses cultivation, **leading to** India's protein insecurity.



Lifting of the export restrictions on rice **is** a signal **India has** managed to **ride out** the food inflation it imported **on account of** the Russia-Ukraine conflict that affected wheat and **edible** oil prices globally. India contributed to the **domino effect** by **embargoing** its grain trade for almost two years. Its recent policy **assurance** will **mitigate** global food vulnerability. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'

Vocabulary

1. **Resume** (verb) – Restart, recommence, continue, begin again, proceed फिर से शुरू करना
prolonged, expanded beyond limit बहुत अधिक विस्तारित
2. **Resumption** (noun) – Restart, continuation, renewal, reopening, recommencement पुनः आरंभ
3. **Outcome** (noun) – Result, consequence, effect, conclusion, aftermath परिणाम
4. **Retail price inflation** (noun) – Increase in prices of goods and services at the consumer level, affecting the cost of living खुदरा मूल्य मुद्रास्फीति
5. **Sojourn** (noun) – Stay, visit, temporary stop, halt, stopover ठहराव
6. **Acreage** (noun) – Land area, cultivated area, farmland, field area, land size खेत का क्षेत्रफल
7. **Stable** (adjective) – Steady, consistent, balanced, unchanging, firm स्थिर
8. **Intervention** (noun) – Involvement, interference, action, mediation, intercession हस्तक्षेप
9. **Curb** (noun) – Restriction, control, restraint, limitation, check प्रतिबंध
10. **Overextended** (adjective) – Overstretched, excessive, too much, prolonged, expanded beyond limit बहुत अधिक विस्तारित
11. **Stockpiling** (noun) – Accumulation, hoarding, collection, amassing, storage भंडारण
12. **Pursuit** (noun) – Effort, quest, search, striving, chase प्रयास
13. **Add to** (phrasal verb) – Increase, enhance, amplify, augment, boost बढ़ाना
14. **Vulnerability** (noun) – Weakness, susceptibility, exposure, defenselessness, risk संवेदनशीलता
15. **Intervention** (noun) – Involvement, interference, action, mediation, intercession हस्तक्षेप
16. **Scrutiny** (noun) – Examination, inspection, investigation, analysis, review जांच
17. **Stubbornly** (adverb) – Persistently, unyieldingly, obstinately, resolutely, steadfastly हठपूर्वक
18. **Contested** (adjective) – Disputed, challenged, debated, controversial, questioned विवादास्पद
19. **Pursue** (verb) – Follow, chase, seek, strive for, engage in पीछा करना

20. **Amid** (preposition) – In the middle of, surrounded by, during, in the midst of, among के बीच में
21. **Manage** (to) (verb) – Succeed in, achieve, accomplish, deal with, handle सफल होना
22. **In place** (phrase) – Established, set up, in position, ready, prepared स्थापित
23. **Considerable** (adjective) – Significant, substantial, extensive, large, noteworthy पर्याप्त
24. **Feed** (by) (verb) – Support, sustain, nourish, encourage, maintain, समर्थन करना
25. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Lead to, cause, bring about, produce, give rise to परिणामस्वरूप होना
26. **Deficient** (adjective) – Lacking, insufficient, inadequate, scarce, meager कमी
27. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Cause, result in, bring about, produce, create कारण बनना
28. **Lift** (verb) – Remove, abolish, cancel, revoke, withdraw हटाना
29. **Ride out** (phrasal verb) – Survive, endure, get through, weather, withstand सहन करना
30. **On account of** (phrase) – Because of, due to, owing to, as a result of, in view of के कारण
31. **Edible** (adjective) – Eatable, consumable, safe to eat, digestible, suitable for consumption खाद्य
32. **Domino effect** (noun) – Chain reaction, ripple effect, cascading effect, knock-on effect, sequence प्रतिक्रिया प्रभाव
33. **Embargo** (verb) – Prohibit, ban, restrict, bar, stop प्रतिबंध लगाना
34. **Assurance** (noun) – Guarantee, promise, pledge, certainty, affirmation आश्वासन
35. **Mitigate** (verb) – Alleviate, lessen, reduce, diminish, ease कम करना

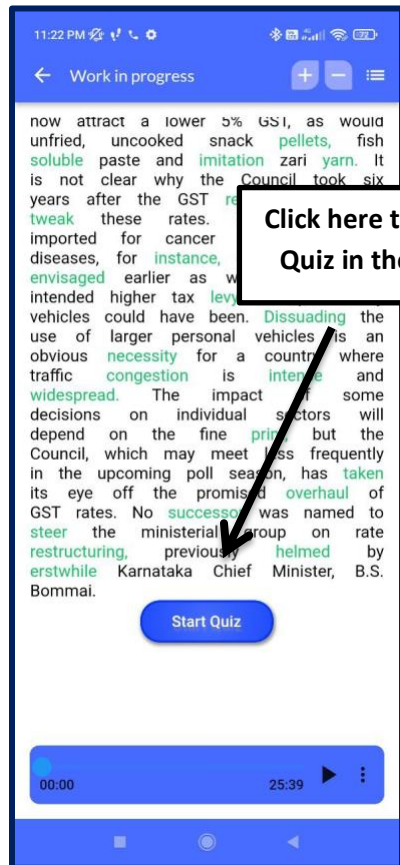
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Resumption of Non-Basmati Rice Exports:** India has resumed its non-basmati rice exports due to stable prices and increased production, signaling positive economic conditions.
2. **Declining Wholesale Prices:** Wholesale rice prices have started to decline, while retail price inflation has dropped back to single digits after staying above 10% for an extended period.
3. **Higher Paddy Acreage:** The main kharif crop's paddy acreage has increased compared to last year, supported by a stable monsoon.
4. **No Need for Supply-Side Interventions:** With stable output and price trends, there is no immediate need for the Government of India (GoI) to impose supply-side interventions like export restrictions or excessive stockpiling.
5. **Impact of Export Restrictions:** India, as the world's largest rice exporter, had to balance domestic food security with global market stability while facing scrutiny over the impact of export curbs on global cereal prices.
6. **Stockpiling Concerns:** India's continued policy of stockpiling grain is contentious, raising concerns about warehousing capacity and whether this approach is necessary.
7. **Decline in Global Market Share:** Despite export curbs, India's share of global rice exports declined by less than a quarter, as competing exporters like Thailand and Vietnam filled the gap.
8. **Global Impact:** China, the world's largest rice producer, does not trade its rice due to high domestic consumption, leading to greater global dependency on India, Thailand, and Vietnam for rice supply.
9. **Nutritional Security Issues:** India's focus on rice production over other crops like pulses results in a lack of diversification, contributing to nutritional insecurity, particularly a deficit in protein sources.
10. **Consequences of Price Support Policies:** India's surplus in rice production is influenced by price support policies that prioritize food security over nutritional security, which could have broader implications for agricultural diversity.
11. **Impact of Global Events:** The resumption of rice exports indicates that India has managed to overcome the food inflation triggered by the Russia-Ukraine conflict, which affected wheat and edible oil prices globally.
12. **Effect of Export Embargoes:** India's embargo on grain trade for almost two years contributed to global food price instability, but its recent policy reversal is expected to stabilize the market.
13. **Policy Assurance:** The lifting of export restrictions is a positive signal that India is confident in managing its domestic food inflation and supply-demand dynamics.

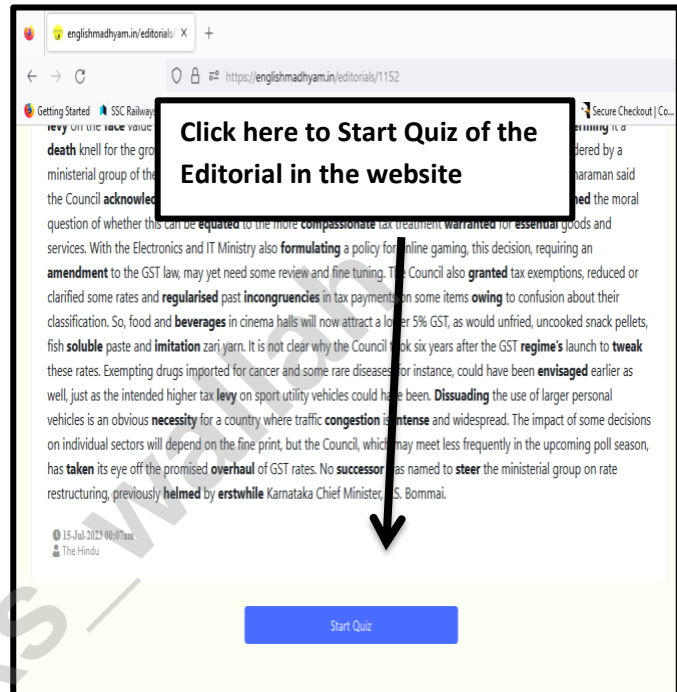
14. **Mitigating Global Food Vulnerability:** The resumption of non-basmati rice exports will help mitigate global food vulnerabilities, reducing the pressure on international food markets.
15. **Improvement in Food Inflation:** The editorial suggests that India's policy reversal will support not only domestic stability but also global food security by ensuring a steady supply of rice.

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Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



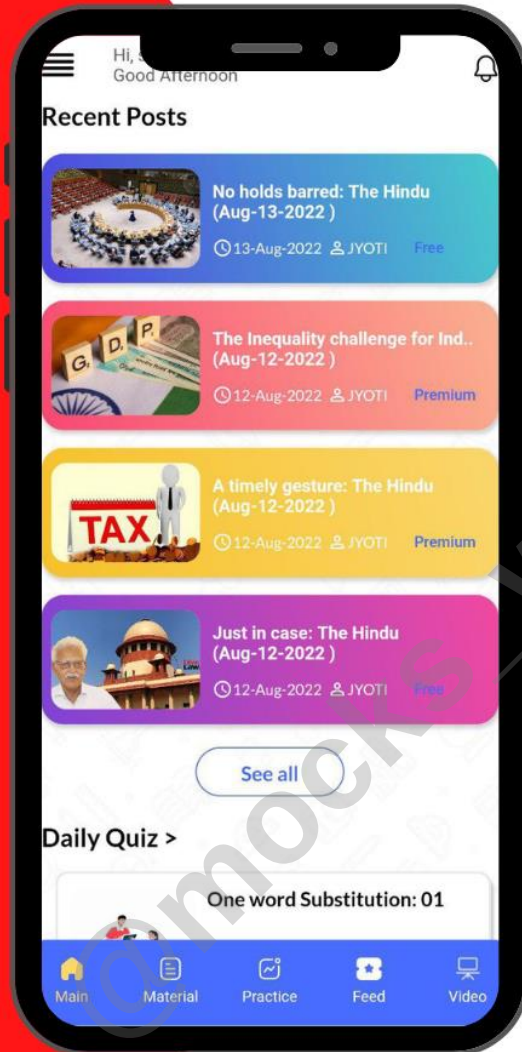
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